

Nima Kelidari

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Education

University of Southern California, Viterbi School of Engineering

Master of Science in Computer Science - Artificial Intelligence

Los Angeles, CA

Dec 2024 – Present

- Currently enrolled in 8 of 32 required graduate-level units in AI/ML Engineering, including Deep Learning, Robotics, and Robotics Lab
- Expanding expertise with additional coursework in Natural Language Processing and Robotics to align with AI/ML career goals

Sharif University of Technology

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | GPA: 3.37/4.0

Tehran, TE

Sep 2019 – Feb 2024

- Completed over 15 undergraduate and graduate courses in CS and AI with an average grade of 3.5/4, covering topics such as Computer Vision, Deep Learning, Statistical Learning, Advanced Programming, Algorithm Design, Numerical Analysis, Data Structures, Image Processing, and Databases
- Built a solid foundation in mathematics and computer science through courses in calculus, linear algebra, automata theory, and basic programming

Professional Experience

Best Buy Co

Technical Sales Advisor

Seattle, WA

May 2024 – Jan 2025

- Worked as a Technical PC Advisor, assisted over 300 customers in selecting suitable electronic devices, while debugging issues and optimizing systems
- Strengthened initiative, teamwork, and leadership skills through assisting 800+ customers and collaborating with employees and managers

Sharif University of Technology

Research Assistant

Tehran, TE

Sep 2022 – Aug 2023

- Conducted ten months of research with Dr. Tefagh, exploring innovative applications of Computer Vision as part of a 4-member team of CS students
- Utilized advanced machine learning methods, such as Vision Transformers and 3D Convolutional Neural Networks, in a complex Generative AI pipeline
- Created teamwork and communication skills while using tools such as version control systems, Google Docs, Google Colab, Kaggle, and GPU servers

Sharif University of Technology

Teaching Assistant and Tutor

Tehran, TE

Sep 2021 – Jul 2023

- Served as Teaching Assistant for 4 semesters across 6 courses, supporting courses in Basic Programming, Advanced Programming, Computer Fundamentals, and Machine Learning, collaborated with fellow TAs as members of a TA team under supervision of professors and university staff
- Presented lectures, pioneered assignments, conducted quizzes, and graded exams and projects for over 300 students, working closely with Head TAs
- Created and delivered TensorFlow workshops and diagnostic sessions for 60 students in a Machine Learning course, with a 65% attendance rate

Projects

Multi-Modal Sentiment Classification

[Link to GitHub](#)

- Established a robust data pipeline to process large scale datasets efficiently, ensuring optimal data flow and organization, working with 2 group mates
- Engineered and deployed classification models across three modalities, attaining 64.5% accuracy on real-world data in predicting a person's mood
- Boosted data science techniques, including data analysis, augmentation, visualization, data mining, and transformation, as well as neural network methodologies such as autoencoders, tokenization, and LSTM, particularly for NLP applications, and also designed detailed documents in 2 languages

Hybrid Anime Recommender System (User Based + Content Based)

[Link to GitHub](#)

- Built a hybrid recommender processing 80M+ user-anime interactions (300k users $\times$ 14k anime) with cold-start filtering and stratified train-test split
- Implemented neural collaborative filtering (matrix factorization + DNN: 256 $\rightarrow$ 128 $\rightarrow$ 64 $\rightarrow$ 32) using TensorFlow/Keras with bias terms and LayerNorm
- Automated MLOps pipeline with Comet ML/DVC tracking, Jenkins for CI/CD, and scalable deployment using Docker/Kubernetes on Google Cloud Run

Adversarial Co-Evolution: LLM-PPO Agent Strategy Transfer

[Link to GitHub](#)

- Engineered a distributed PPO training pipeline (SB3/PyTorch) with custom action masking, enforcing 100% move validity in complex state spaces
- Architected a Master-Worker LLM inference system to decouple game logic from generation latency, enabling Llama-3/GPT-OSS agents as adversaries
- Deployed a robust 3-phase curriculum learning system with self-play, achieving a 99.1% win rate by self enhancement and preventing strategy collapse
- Developed a full-stack scientific dashboard for real-time training and testing monitoring, live prompt engineering, and qualitative model validation

Skills

Programming: Python (Fluent), Java (Fluent), SQL (Fluent), C++, R | **Frameworks:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, Pandas, Scikit-learn, NumPy, Matplotlib, SciPy, OpenCV | **Platforms:** GitHub, GitLab, Jupyter, Google Colab, Kaggle | **Data Systems:** MySQL, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, DVC, Apache Airflow | **Cloud & DevOps:** Google Cloud, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins, MLflow, Grafana, Comet

Strengths

Teamwork and Collaboration: Developed teamwork skills through bachelor's project, teaching assistant, and professional work
Communication skills: Demonstrated communication and leadership through teamwork in academic and professional experience
Continuous Learning & Adaptability: Possess a strong desire to explore new concepts and a motivation to adapt to new topics